NFC Tag Installation Guide

Rapid Cortex Campus · Rapid Cortex Venue

Step-by-step guide to programming and attaching NFC tags using only Rapid Cortex — no third-party NFC apps.

15 minutes	No technical skills needed	Works on any smartphone

Overview

An NFC (Near Field Communication) tag is a small sticker — about the size of a coin — that contains a tiny chip. When a smartphone is held near it, the phone opens a web page. No camera, no app download, and no typing for the person reporting.

For Rapid Cortex, each NFC tag is programmed with a unique reporting URL tied to your agency and location. You create the code in the browser, then write the tag with the **RC Mobile App**. When someone taps the sign, they go directly to the safety reporting form for that exact location.

NOTE NFC tags and QR codes on the same sign point to the same location. They work identically — NFC is faster for newer phones; QR covers every camera.

Trade show and Rapid Cortex booth signs

Booth visitors should open the public Rapid Cortex site — not a campus or venue report form. Do not create a location code for a trade-show sign. In the RC Mobile App (Campus or Venue), tap **Trade show signs**, choose **Home** or **Demo**, print the QR, then tap **Program NFC Tag**.

1. **Home**
   https://www.rapidcortex.us — company homepage.
2. **Demo**
   https://www.rapidcortex.us/demo/ — product demo page.

WARNING A location tag on a booth sign opens a safety report form. Always use Trade show signs for Rapid Cortex marketing URLs. Stay in the RC app — do not use NFC Tools or another writer.

What You Need

The Rapid Cortex browser and mobile app do the programming. You only buy blank NTAG213 stickers.

Item	Details	Where to get it
RC admin account	Agency Admin or higher · same login as the mobile app	app.rapidcortex.us
RC Mobile App	Writes NFC tags and can scan/verify QR codes · no NFC Tools or other apps	App Store / Google Play — search Rapid Cortex
NTAG213 NFC stickers	Pack of 100 · round or square · white finish	Amazon — search “NTAG213 NFC stickers” (~$15–20 / 100)
Smartphone with NFC	iPhone 7 or newer · most Android phones since 2014	You already have this
Permanent marker (optional)	Label tag backs with the location name	Any office supply store
Isopropyl alcohol wipes (optional)	Clean the sign surface before sticking	Amazon or pharmacy

TIP	NTAG213 is the most compatible chip type. NTAG215 / NTAG216 work but cost more for no benefit in this use case.

1 Create the location in the browser

Each physical sign location gets its own unique code. You generate it in the Rapid Cortex web app — you do not paste URLs into any other app.

1	**Log in to the Rapid Cortex web app** Go to app.rapidcortex.us and sign in with your admin account.
2	**Open QR & NFC** From the sidebar, select your agency, then click QR & NFC. RC platform admins go to RC Admin → Agencies → [Agency] → QR & NFC.
3	**Tap "+ New QR / NFC Code"** Enter the name and location of this sign (e.g., "McKinley Hall — 3rd Floor"), select the report type and vertical, and save.
4	**Leave the URL in Rapid Cortex** The RC Mobile App writes the correct URL for you. You do not need to copy it into NFC Tools or any other writer.

WARNING	Create a separate code for each physical sign location. Do not reuse the same URL across multiple locations — you will not be able to tell which location a report came from.

2 Program the NFC tag in the RC Mobile App

This takes about 10 seconds per tag once you know the steps. You only need to do this once per tag. The RC app writes the URL — no third-party NFC utility.

1	**Download the RC Mobile App** Search "Rapid Cortex" in the App Store (iOS) or Google Play (Android). Sign in with the same account you use on the web.
2	**Open QR & NFC** Select your agency, then open the location you just created.
3	**Tap Program NFC Tag** The app activates NFC and waits for a tag. You do not paste a URL.
4	**Hold an NTAG213 to the back of the phone** iPhone: near the top edge. Android: center back. Hold still for about 2 seconds until the app shows Tag programmed successfully.
5	**Write another tag if needed** Use Write Another in the app for extra tags at the same location. Each tap is counted separately.

TIP	If the write fails, move the tag slowly around the back of the phone until you find the NFC antenna. On iPhone it is near the top edge. On Android it is usually in the center.

3 Test the tag before attaching

Always test before mounting. Testing takes 30 seconds and prevents pulling a tag out from under a sign.

1	**Tap the programmed tag with a locked-awake phone** Screen on, no app required for the person reporting. Hold the tag to the NFC antenna.

2	**Confirm the Rapid Cortex report form opens** You should see the safety reporting form for this location and vertical.
3	**Optional: verify the printed QR in the RC app** Use Scan QR Code in the RC Mobile App to confirm the printed PNG before you mount.
4	**Check the dashboard** In the RC web app, confirm the NFC tap count for this code increased by 1.

CAUTION If the form does not open: confirm NFC is enabled (Settings → NFC), rewrite the tag from the RC Mobile App (Program NFC Tag), and hold the tag at the antenna location.

4 Attach the tag to the sign

1	**Label the tag (recommended)** Before peeling, write the location name on the tag (e.g., “MH-3F”). Helps if a tag ever comes loose.
2	**Clean the mounting surface (optional)** Wipe the back of the sign with isopropyl alcohol and let dry 30 seconds.
3	**Peel and press** Center the tag on the back of the sign. Press firmly 10–15 seconds.
4	**Mount the sign** Install in the final location. Anyone with a smartphone can tap the front of the sign to report.
5	**Final tap test** Hold your phone to the front of the mounted sign. Confirm the form still opens.

Sign material compatibility

NFC works differently depending on what the sign is made of.

Material	NFC works?	Notes
Acrylic / Plexiglass	Yes	Best option. Tag reads clearly through any thickness.
PVC / Foam board	Yes	Reads through up to 1/2 inch thickness.
Plastic	Yes	Works on any non-metallic plastic.
Wood	Yes	Works through standard sign thickness.
Glass	Yes	Reads through glass. Stick tag to inner surface.
Aluminum (face)	Partial	Aluminum blocks NFC. Mount tag on the face (not back) in a corner, or use a mounting block.
Solid metal back	No	Metal blocks the signal. Use a non-metallic plate between tag and metal, or attach nearby.

5 Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Phone does not detect the tag	Enable NFC: iPhone Control Center / Android Settings → Connected devices → NFC. Move the tag slowly across the phone back.

Wrong page opens	Rewrite the tag from the RC Mobile App (Program NFC Tag). NTAG213 tags can be overwritten. Do not use NFC Tools or another writer.
Tag detected but no page opens	Rewrite from the RC app so the tag gets a full https:// Rapid Cortex URL.
Tag stopped working after mounting	Too close to metal. Move to a non-metallic area or use an on-metal / anti-metal NFC tag.
Tap count not updating	Count increments when the reporting form loads. Check connectivity at the sign location.
Correct form, wrong location name	Update the zone name in the Rapid Cortex dashboard. No need to rewrite the tag.
Adhesive came loose	Clean with isopropyl alcohol, dry fully, and re-stick. For permanent installs, a small amount of clear super glue around the edge.
App says write failed	NFC must be on. Hold the tag still. Use an NTAG213. Stay in the RC Mobile App — do not switch to a third-party NFC utility.

6 Quick reference card

Print and keep with your NFC tag supplies.

Supplies ■ NTAG213 NFC sticker tags ■ Smartphone with NFC ■ RC Mobile App (not NFC Tools) ■ RC admin login ■ Permanent marker (optional) ■ Isopropyl wipes (optional)	**Installation steps** 1. Create the location at app.rapidcortex.us → QR & NFC 2. Open RC app → that location → Program NFC Tag 3. Hold NTAG213 to the phone until success 4. Test tap — confirm the form opens 5. Optional: Scan QR Code in the RC app 6. Label, clean, peel, stick, mount 7. Final tap test after mounting

Need help? Contact Rapid Cortex Support — support@rapidcortex.us · www.rapidcortex.us